PRACTICAL 10

PHP Session Management, Authentication, and Role-Based Access Control

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Program / Semester	3rd
Course / Subject	WEB DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK
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1. Aim

To implement secure user authentication, session management, role-based access control (Admin vs. Student), and session timeout handling using PHP and MySQL.

2. Practical Requirements

• Authentication & Session Handling – Implement login authentication using password_verify() and secure sessions with session ID regeneration (authenticate.php).
• Role-Based Access Control – Restrict access to admin_dashboard.php and student_dashboard.php based on the user's role.
• Session Timeout & Logout – Handle session timeouts securely (timeout.php) and destroy sessions upon user logout (logout.php).
• Database Integration – Connect to the database via db.php using MySQLi to verify user credentials.

3. Required Screenshots / Demonstration

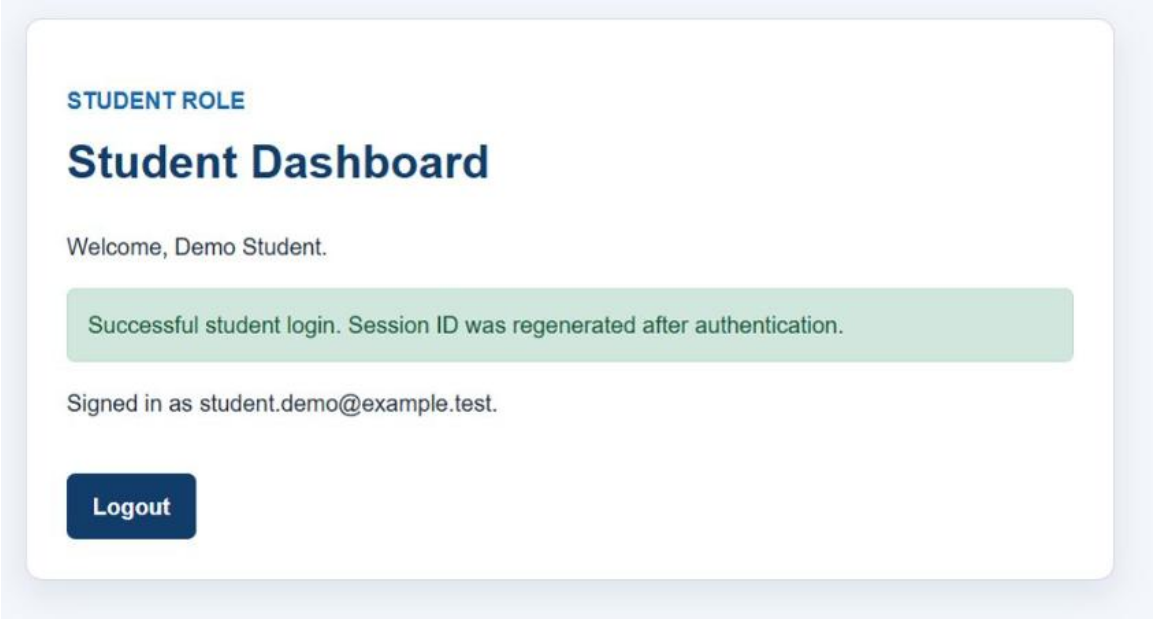
Insert the screenshots below in the same order as the practical instructions.

>http://localhost/studentHUB/student_dashboard.php<

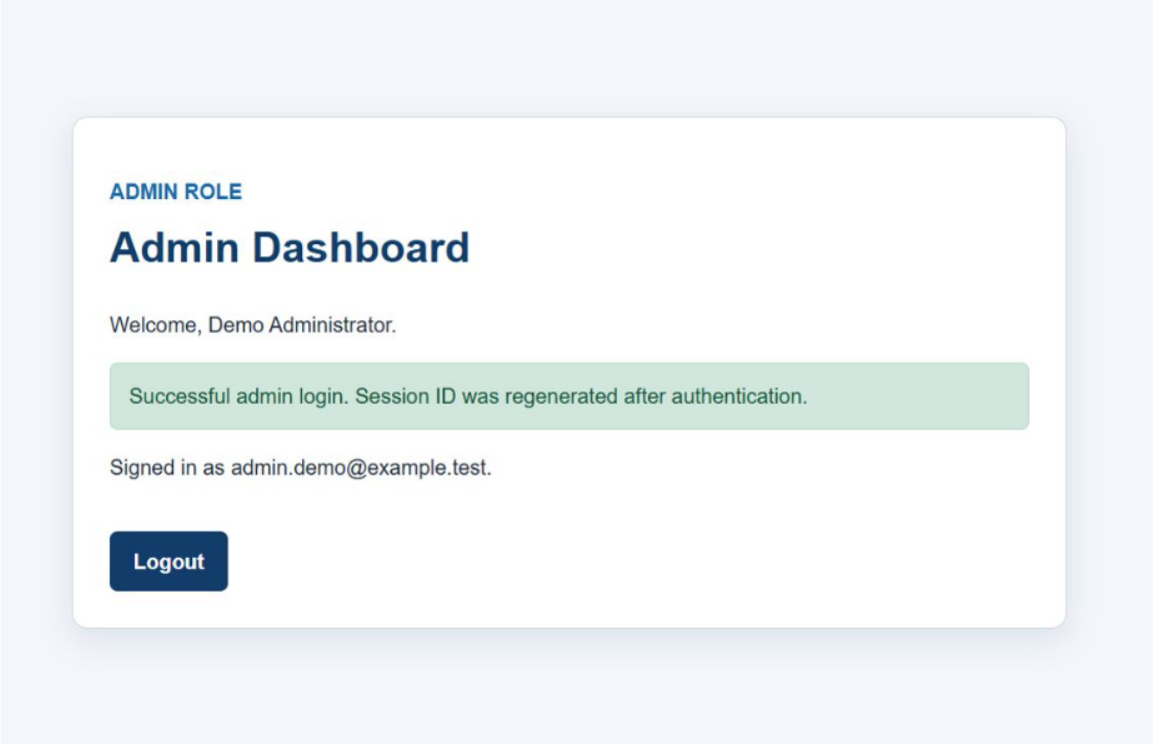
>http://localhost/studentHUB/login.php< ,etc

Done using this this urls on localhost…….

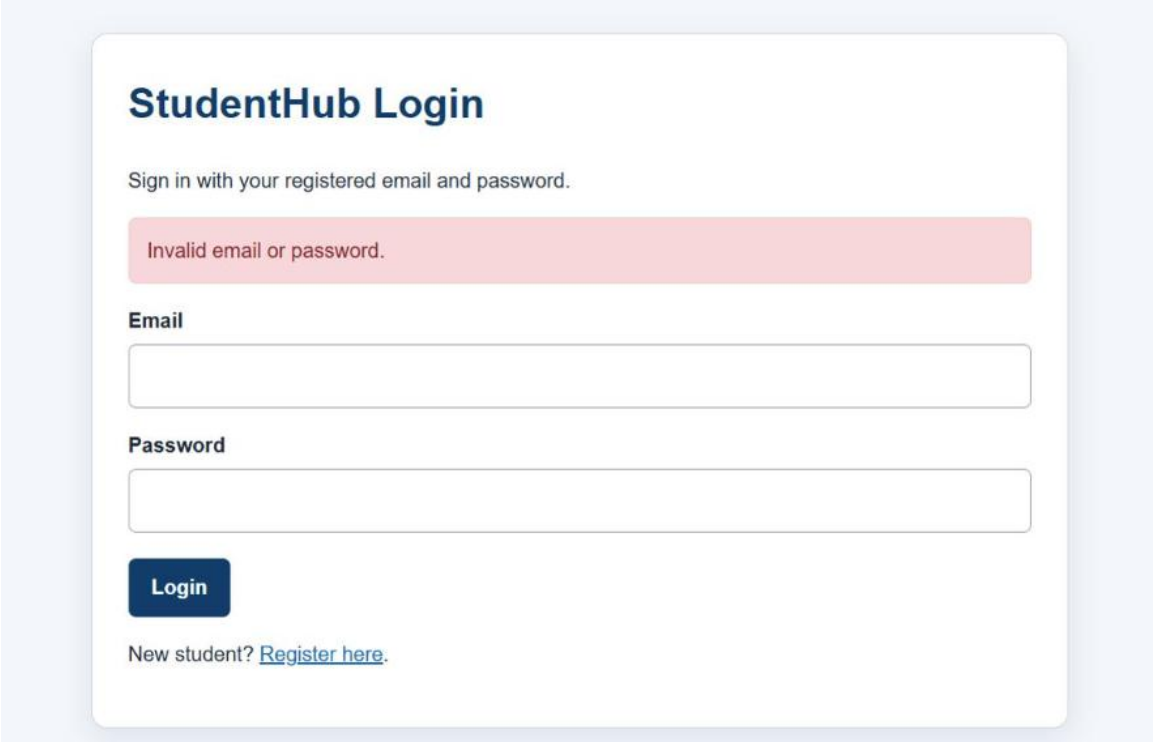
3.1 Successful student login



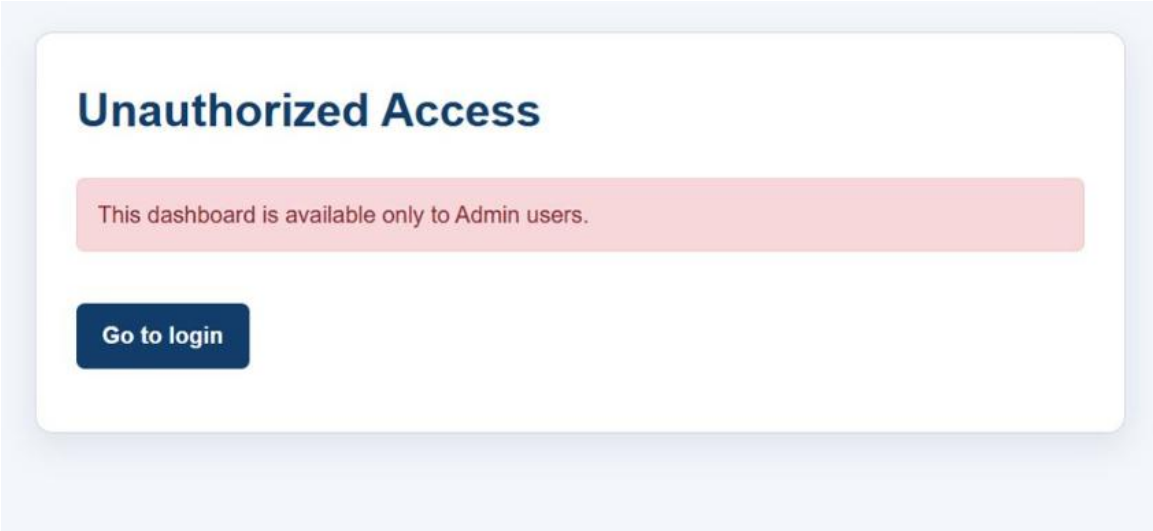
3.2 Successful admin login



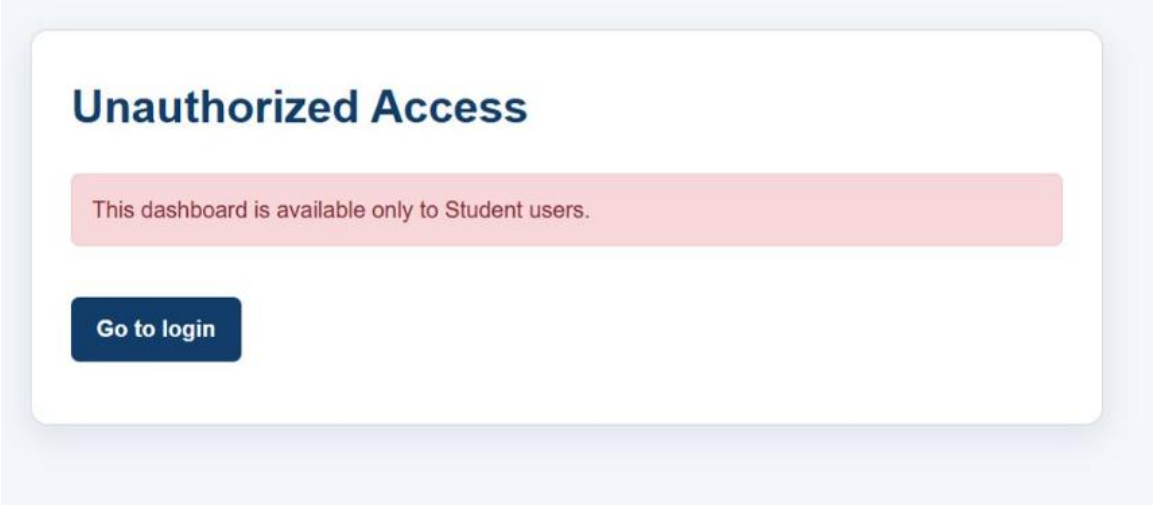
3.3 Invalid email/password message



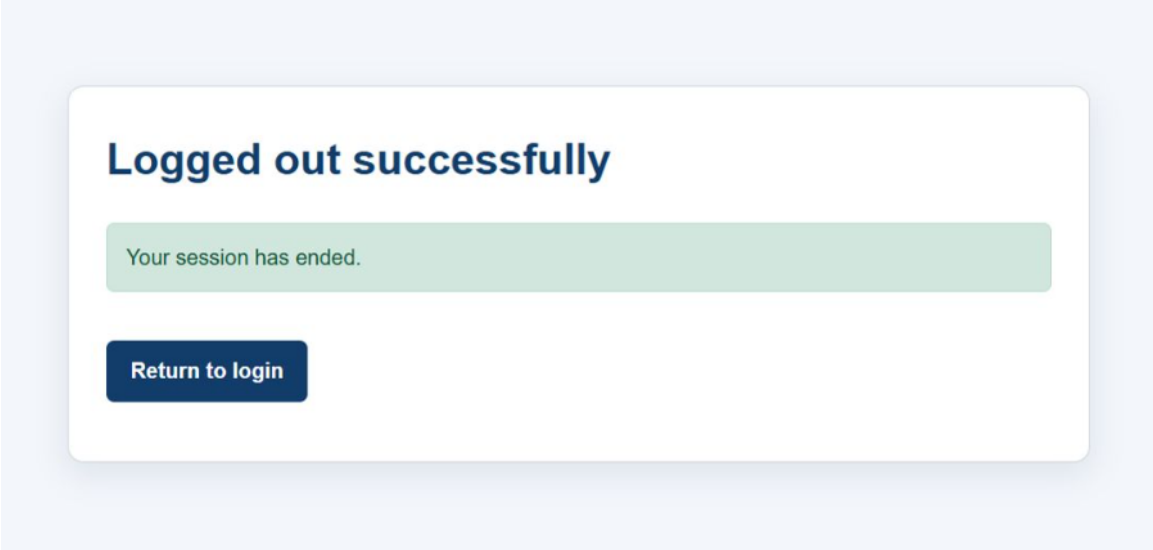
3.4 Student attempting to access the admin dashboard (Unauthorized Access)



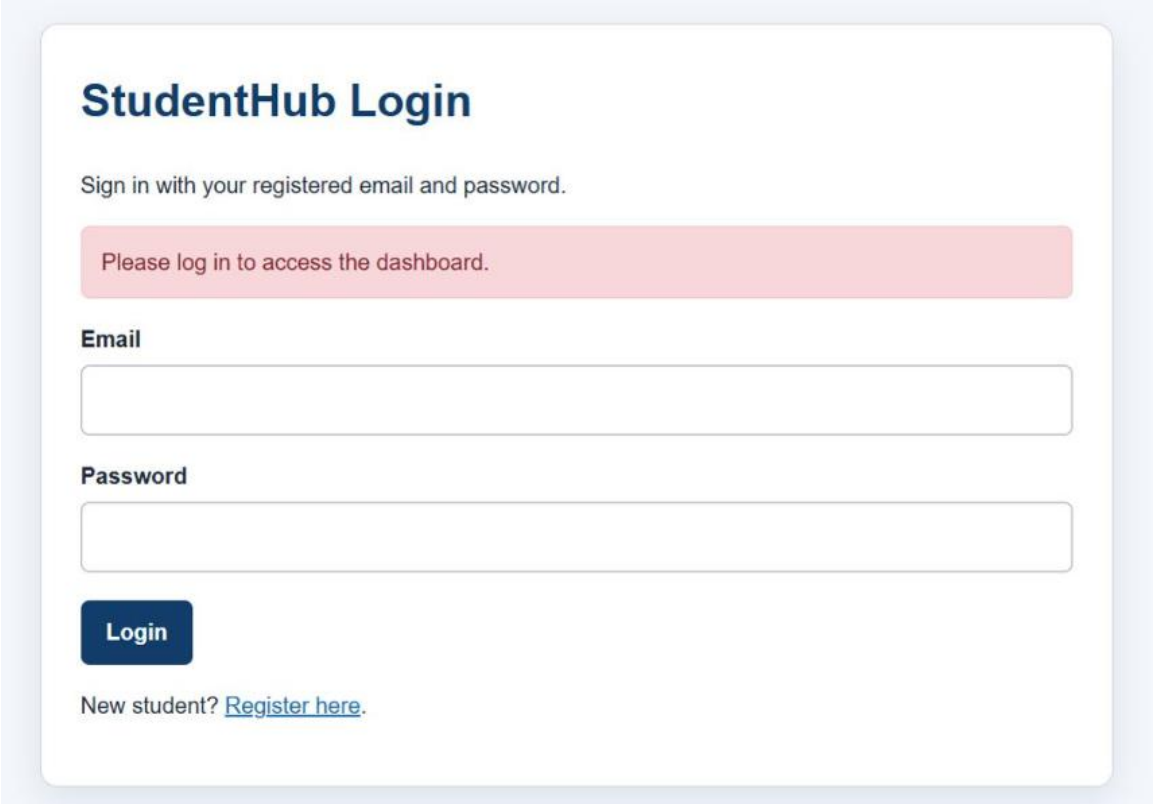
3.5 Admin attempting to access the student dashboard (Unauthorized Access)



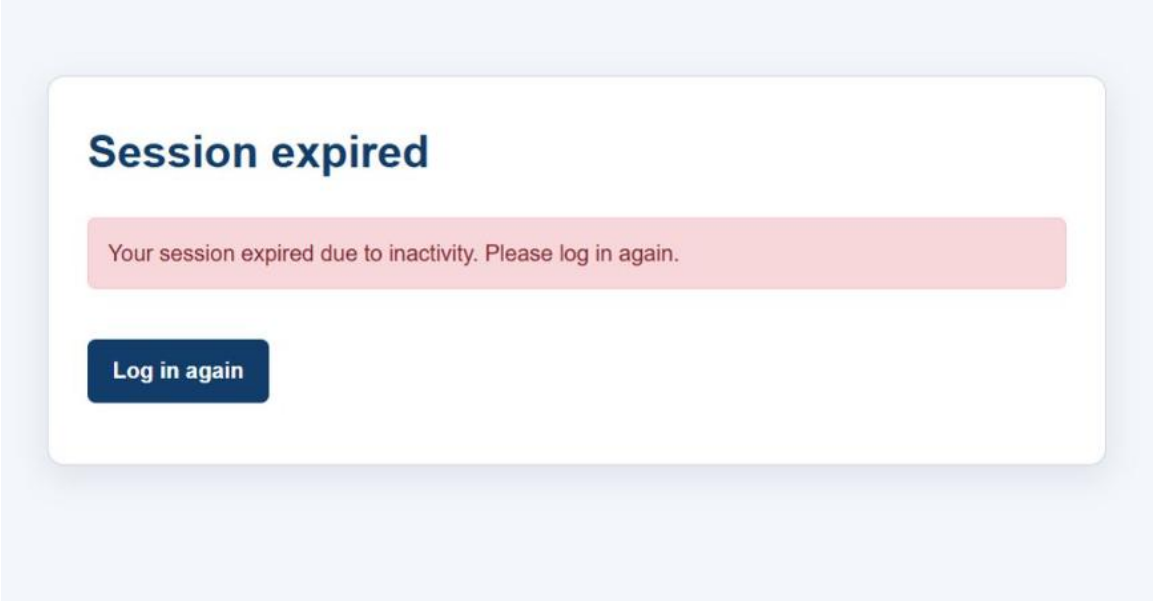
3.6 Successful logout



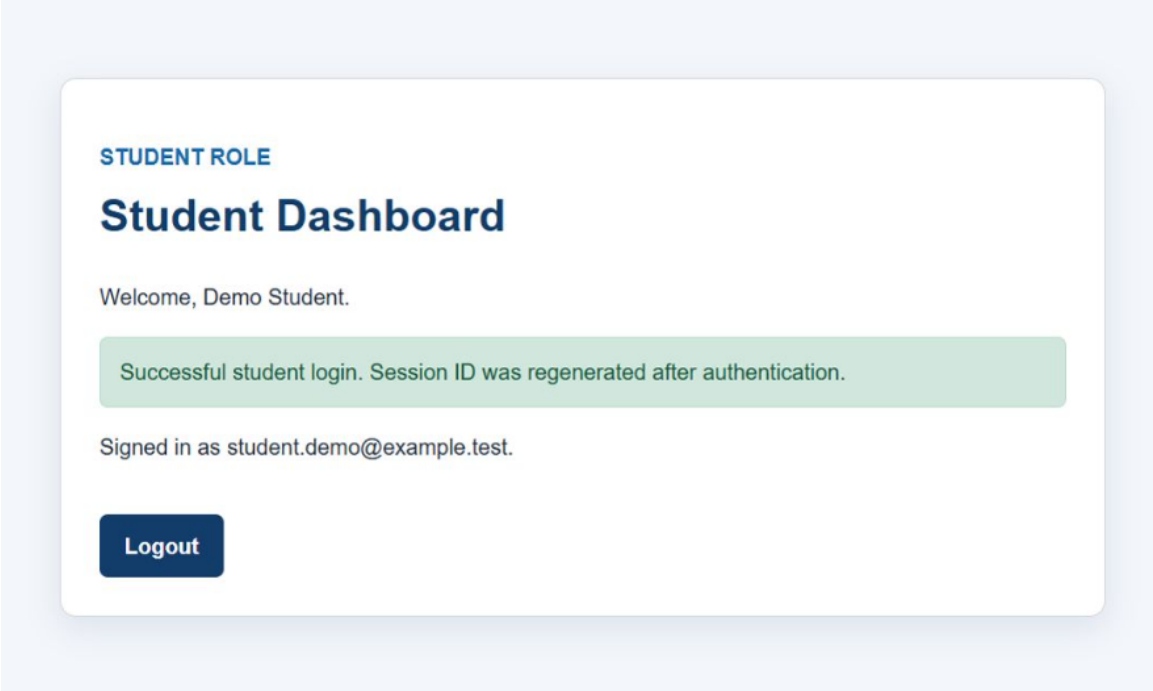
3.7 Dashboard access denied after logout



3.8 Session timeout and redirection to login



3.9 Session ID regeneration after successful login



5. Result

The secure authentication system was successfully implemented. Users can log in using verified credentials, and sessions are properly managed with session ID regeneration. Role-based access control accurately restricts students from admin pages and vice versa. Timeout and logout mechanisms successfully destroy active sessions and prevent unauthorized access.

6. Conclusion

This practical demonstrates the essential mechanisms of secure web application authentication. Implementing password verification, session ID regeneration, and role-based dashboards ensures robust security against unauthorized access and session hijacking, establishing a strong foundation for user-driven web platforms.

— End of Practical 10 Submission —